

Module 2: Philosophies of Education

EDUC 219 - Howard University

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1 Module overview

This module introduces historical traditions and contemporary discourses in philosophies of education. We will examine how philosophical ideas shape beliefs about the purposes of education, the role of schools in democratic society, the relationships among knowledge, learning, teaching, and citizenship, and the distribution of educational opportunity.

2 Guiding questions

- What is a philosophy of education?
- What purposes should education and schools serve in a democratic society?
- How have major philosophical traditions shaped American educational thought and practice?
- How do different philosophies understand knowledge, learning, authority, curriculum, and citizenship?

3 Key concepts

- Philosophy of education
- Democratic education
- Educational aims and purposes
- Knowledge and curriculum
- Authority and freedom
- Equality, equity, and access
- Diversity and multiculturalism
- Social justice
- Professional identity and agency

4 James Banks

4.1 Multicultural Education

James Banks developed a framework for integrating multicultural content into curricula. His work emphasizes five dimensions:

- Content integration
- Knowledge construction
- Prejudice reduction
- Equity pedagogy
- An empowering school culture and social structure

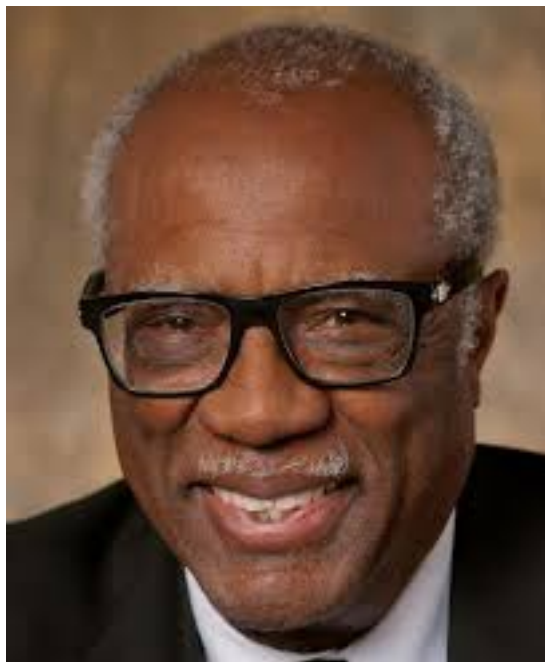


Figure 1: James Banks, University of Washington

Multicultural education involves more than adding diverse figures or holidays to the curriculum; it also requires examining how knowledge is constructed and how school structures distribute opportunity.

5 Django Paris

5.1 Culturally Sustaining Pedagogy

Django Paris extended culturally relevant pedagogy through an explicit focus on **sustaining** linguistic, literate, and cultural pluralism in schooling.